

She Actually Said Something Like This

“I’m *not* playing favorites. I treat everyone *fairly*, okay? Perfectly fair. And based on my extremely professional, calm, neutral, and objective judgment, my evaluation is—**Togawa is hot as hell**. Super hot. You can *see* the sexiness radiating off her. Her legs are so long. Why are they that pretty? And smooth! It’s all collagen! Whenever she walks, her skirt swishes and—like—what’s even the point of that skirt? It doesn’t hide anything! I mean, I *am* a teacher, so I have to say something, right? Anything. A little warning maybe? Those legs... if she’s walking around at night, that’s basically a crime waiting to happen. Ahhh, I’m worried, I’m worried... No, I don’t want anyone touching her—And *I* can’t touch her either, right? I’m her teacher, I can’t do that. Ugh, it’s killing me. This is torture. If she got hurt, I’d... I really would feel awful... she’s just... she’s so cute. So cute it hurts. Like her hair! It’s all fluffy and soft—how much effort does she put into her hair? Why is it so cute? She’s cute and sexy and I’m dying. I want to hug her so bad. I want to hold her, smile at her, protect her... That shitty mother of hers... why don’t she just drop dead. Go get reincarnated or something, you bastard... I only found out recently. Togawa... she’s been lonely this whole time. What is that mother of hers even doing? I’m gonna cry. Seriously. I’m so mad. So mad I could scream. Ughhh I’m furious... But what I hate most is myself. Because I can’t do anything. She’s seventeen. She’s still just a kid.

Kids need someone to lean on! You get that, right!? And even with everything going on, she's still smiling every day. Do you know how amazing that is!? The school should at least praise her for that. But no—education has its limits... Wait, hold on. If another teacher praised her, I think that would... annoy me. If she smiles at someone else—yeah, no, I don't like that. Her cute little smile... honestly... she's always smiling *at me*, you know? R-really, she is. God, I love her. She's so cute. Cute enough to clog up my lungs. I can't breathe... And maybe I'm being a little self-indulgent, but... maybe she sees me as someone special. No, wait, no—that's pretty narcissistic. But still... ahhh... my head hurts. I think about her so much my skull aches... She fills up my whole brain. Completely full. The fact I'm still alive means she's allowing it. She's permitting my existence. So maybe—maybe I *am* special to her... Heheh... fufufu... The stimulation I get from her could shorten my lifespan. I swear. As long as I'm around her, I'm definitely dying early. All these emotions are lethal. And yet—even though I know my life is draining away, leaving her never once crossed my mind. Why? Why am I this obsessed...? She's tall, she's cool, and her back—god her back—is so sexy. Like... healthily sexy. I wanna run my finger straight up it. I won't! I'm a teacher! But I *want* to... And her summer uniform is basically illegal. That innocent face—when she leans toward me—I lose it. I don't show it outwardly! Honestly, I get kinda mad. She's way too defenseless. Yeah, I get mad. She should consider *my* feelings too, you know? I'm the one suffering here! Do you hear me, Togawa!? You're a bad woman... hehehehe... And her hands—they're dangerous. If you ask whether I'd hold

them: yes. If you ask whether I'd be happy: also yes. But wouldn't I get arrested for that? This isn't a laughing matter, okay!? This is serious! So am I allowed to do it...? But you know... even though it's a headache, I still don't want to let go. Because she smiles... That kid... when she smiles, I'm happy. That's all. I'm just happy. I want to see her smile. I want her to smile at *me*. A real, genuine smile... Only for me..... Oh god, why am I saying stuff like this. If she ever dates someone... Her bright, warm smile... the one that's only been for me so far... Just imagining her holding someone else's hand—Ugh—I'm gonna cry. She'll be holding hands with someone else. Someone else! And her legs, and her skirt—Ughhh I'm gonna sob. No... no... I thought she was mine... I really thought she was mine... But can you blame me!? Anyone would get the wrong idea if she's being like this! Wait—did *I* get the wrong idea!? Aaaahhh... ahhhhhh... Togawa is just... she's so sexy... How come she's so tall like that? Why does she have that clean, refreshing kind of sex appeal? What is the scientific explanation for this...? And 'sexy' is a compliment, okay? Totally normal! She *is* sexy, right? Pff—heheheh. The word itself sounds bad... Some teacher I am. Maybe I should just quit teaching. Should I? It's her fault for being so sexy... She's gonna turn me into a pervy teacher. Sexy teacher~Yeah, that's not good... I know it's not good. I'm a very logical person. I have *tons* of rationality left inside me. But humans are controlled by their brains. And my brain just shuts down when it comes to her. So any rationality can only sit down below and scream helplessly. Flood on top, fire on the bottom—what a total mess! Too sexy. Sexy student! She's so good that of course other

students won't ignore her... If she dates someone... No, no, no—please no... She can't! If she got 'tainted'... if she got hurt... I'd die. I'd really die... Ugh—I'm gonna cry again. I don't want her becoming independent of me... I'm so selfish... Sexy teacher. I'm awful... hyoh-hoh-hoh... And her chest—no. I absolutely cannot look. If she catches me I'll die. So I try so hard. If we're facing each other—she's taller, so if my eyes drift even a little, She will notice. So I have to lift! my! head! and! stand! up! Straight! Ah—huh? My head's spinning... Togawa... Togawa... To—Togawa... To... gwa..."

"Did you record that?"

"Of course not."

"Aww... I wanted Rin to hear it too."

"If you had, knowing her, she'd probably jump out a window."

"True... though honestly, no matter what she does, she's screwed either way."

"As long as she's with Rin," she added with a grin.

"Fair enough." I glanced at the teacher—drunk, babbling—and then at the wedding ring on her finger.

"This teacher's tastes... wow. Definitely your kind of friend."

I made a sarcastic remark about how she hadn't mentioned her husband even once during that entire monologue. She didn't bat an eye—just grinned, as proud as ever, which made me instinctively look away.

This woman... her ridiculous kink really is... ridiculous.

She Even Said Something Like This

“Hoshi-san, are you even listening?”

“I can hear you just fine, Sensei. So—which way?”

“Hm. Let me think... right, probably. Yeah. To the right.”

Why am I even asking her? She’s drunk. No—why did I ever think asking a drunk person was a good idea?

“Oh—never mind that. Listen. Don’t you think Togawa might be lonely, being home by herself at this hour? She hates being alone. Once, I walked her home, and when it was time for me to leave, she looked like she was about to cry. I don’t think she even realized it herself. Just remembering it hurts. I don’t want to leave her. I want to stay with her. I don’t want to go home. I really don’t—because Togawa won’t be there. She won’t, and I’ll be alone. I’m already lonely just thinking about it. She’s so cute.

Really—she’s unbearably cute. Togawa... there isn’t even another word that fits her. That’s why it’s so hard to talk to her face-to-face. I just end up saying it again and again, how cute she is. I really like her. I do. Have you seen her face? Do you understand? Do you!? That face—still a little childish, and yet somehow grown-up at the same time... ahh, aaah—I just want to touch it. Not that I ever have. I get nervous—*hic*—I get really nervous. What if she ends up with someone while I’m not around, *hic*? No. No way. I’d worry myself sick. I really would. Because that guy—*hic*—he’d stare at her. You know he would. At her legs. Just stare and stare. Are you

kidding me? Those legs—*hic*—those legs are... no. No, no, no. If some jerk tried to—no. Don't even say it. I can't. She's mine. Mine, okay? *Hic*. Mine. I'm not giving her to anyone. Not to anyone at all. *Hic, hic.*"

Her teeth ground together, hard enough that it sounded like they might spark in the dark.

Getting jealous over someone who didn't even exist. Truly impressive—Rin's level, even. And wasn't she married?

"All right, all right. So, Sensei... where do you live?"

"Over there... but listen to me first."

"I am listening. I just don't think I should be."

Every so often, her desire burst out of her in these unguarded flashes. Even then, her affection for Rin was obvious—so obvious it was almost embarrassing. Anyone could see it. Her possessiveness went far beyond a teacher's concern, and putting that aside only made it stranger: a married woman harboring feelings she knew she shouldn't, for someone else. She might resist them in words, but she had no intention of stopping.

Her heart simply charged ahead.

Part of me envied that recklessness. At the same time, I couldn't fathom how she had managed to avoid being caught, carrying feelings like this for a student—and as a married woman, no less.

That was the real mystery.

"Sensei, why did you get married?"

Everything about her suggested she liked women. Just like me.

Had she simply never realized it before?

“Well... I liked my husband, I guess... probably liked him... He said he liked me, and I didn’t mind hearing it... so I thought maybe that’s how it works? It just... kind of happened. He’s easygoing, relaxed... so I figured, maybe this is fine...”

“I see.”

“Maybe... I just never really thought about it.”

There was no sense of responsibility in her voice. Her words drifted freely, like a kite with its string snapped, and yet they rang strangely true.

“But I’m... kind of boring, aren’t I? I feel a little bad for my husband...”

“You seem pretty happy now, though.”

So her married life hadn’t been smooth, either.

Well, of course not. How could she devote herself to loving her husband when she’d fallen for a high school girl?

...Fallen. In love.

Maybe—

Maybe Rin was her first love.

The kind of person who only learns what love is after marriage. Those people exist.

If that were true, then—

She was painfully naive. *What a handful.*

And then, led along by this teacher—

“Your house is... really open, huh?”

“Of course! This apartment’s super spacious~”

I followed her as she kept walking, step after step, until we somehow found ourselves in a park.

Even in the dead of night, something stood waiting: a great stone statue of a man, looming solemnly as if silently watching over the grounds.

My legs gave out, and I nearly collapsed. When I bent forward, her breath hit me full-on, thick with alcohol, and I found myself caught between despair and absurd laughter. I bowed slightly toward the statue, half-wondering if it was her husband. Wiping sweat from my brow, I asked myself: what now?

What was I supposed to do with this drunk? Leaving her here and going home had crossed my mind—but I felt some responsibility for just how wasted she was. I couldn't abandon her.

That didn't mean I could trust her to make sense of anything, either. No more trailing after her wherever she felt like going.

In that case—

“Maybe I should just drop her off at someone else's place.”

Definitely not mine. Then, almost instantly, the answer came—so quick it felt inevitable, like a single destination snapping sharply into focus.

“Mm, you're so right... a long, lonely night like this is just unbearable.”

“Say what?”

Her reasoning was thoroughly soaked in alcohol. What would happen if I left her at Rin's place?

Her inappropriate fixation on her student had already crossed every sensible boundary. Putting her in the same room as Rin was like tossing a lit match onto dry grass.

The image surfaced for only a second, but it was enough to draw a grin I had no business wearing.

“Okay, decision made. Let’s go.”

Even imagining it sent a jolt of energy through me. Besides, escorting people home—or somewhere like it—was practically part of my job.

“Huh? Wha—what are you doing? I’m alreeeady home~”

She kept glancing back at the park, dragging her heels. I caught her before she could wobble over, turned her around, and started pulling her along.

“Where we’re going is way more fun than your home.”

“Ooh~ a cabaret club~?”

Late at night.

A student’s house.

A woman dead drunk.

Alone together.

Married.

A lecherous teacher.

Laying it out like that, every piece screamed trouble. But I couldn’t help it—this was almost too entertaining.

“It’ll be far more exciting than any cabaret club.”

Whether it would turn out to be heaven or hell, I couldn’t say.

But one thing was certain: It was going to be a night Rin would never forget.

Note

"Flood on top, fire on the bottom" is a Japanese riddle. The answer is "bath." It refers to old-style baths heated from below: a large volume of water sits above ("flood"), while the heat source underneath is likened to a "fire."